How ChatGPT accesses Optum benefits

CIMD discovery, user authentication, and authorized MCP access

User / Browser	ChatGPT	Optum MCP Gateway	Ping Authorization Server	OpenAI Metadata	What happens
Step 1 — Protected tool request "Show my Optum benefits."					ChatGPT tries to retrieve the user's benefits. The gateway requires authorization and returns instructions for discovering the sign-in process.
	1a. POST /mcp — without token				
	1b. 401 Unauthorized ",				
Step 2 — Discover the authorization server					The gateway tells ChatGPT which authorization server protects the MCP and which permission the benefits request needs.
	2a. GET /.well-known/oauth-protected-resource				
	2b. 200 OK				
Step 3 — Discover Ping's OAuth configuration					ChatGPT learns where to send the user, where to obtain tokens, and that Ping supports CIMD, PKCE, and signed client authentication in this example.
	3a. GET /.well-known/oauth-authorization-server				
	3b. 200 OK				
Step 4 — Open sign-in					The user opens Optum sign-in. ChatGPT identifies itself using its CIMD URL and includes a PKCE challenge to protect the authorization-code flow.
4a. Sign in to Optum.					
4b. GET /oauth/authorize					
Step 5 — Retrieve ChatGPT's CIMD document			**5a. GET /oauth/client.json · CIMD lookup** **5b. 200 OK**		Ping fetches ChatGPT's published client details, checks the permitted callback, and learns where its public keys are published. CIMD supplies client metadata without a separate registration request.
Step 6 — Authenticate user and obtain consent					The user signs in and approves benefits access. Ping redirects the browser to ChatGPT with an authorization code. The access token is obtained in the next exchange.
6a. Optum login and consent page					
6b. Sign in and approve access					
6c. 302 redirect to ChatGPT callback					
6d. OAuth callback					
Step 7 — Redeem the authorization code					ChatGPT submits the authorization code, its original PKCE verifier, and a signed client assertion. The assertion proves possession of ChatGPT's private key.
	7a. POST /oauth/token · Authorization code redemption + client authentication				
Step 8 — Validate the request and issue a token			**8a. GET /oauth/jwks.json — if keys are not cached** **8b. 200 OK**		Ping verifies ChatGPT's signed assertion using OpenAI's public keys and validates the code and PKCE proof. It then issues an access token intended for Optum's MCP.
	8c. 200 OK — access token				
Step 9 — Authorize and execute the tool					The gateway checks the token and confirms which member information the user may access. It executes the permitted request, and ChatGPT explains the returned benefits.
	9a. POST /mcp				
	9b. 200 OK — authorized benefits				
9c. Explain authorized benefits					



Illustrative workflow. Optum's integration is already connected in ChatGPT. Ping CIMD support and configuration are assumed. MCP initialization and session details are omitted.

Illustrative payloads; query and form parameters shown decoded.

Solid arrow: request

Dashed: response